

PATNA | All Is Not Well



KRISHNA MURARI KISHAN

Just a day after Chief Minister Nitish Kumar insisted all is well after watching Aamir Khan's *3 Idiots*, the Janata Dal-United (JD-U) turned unwell. This was because state President Rajiv Ranjan Singh "Lallan" resigned to protest against the "autocratic ways of

NITISH WITH SINGH

the chief minister". Not so long ago, Singh was Nitish's closest associate. His resignation has also brought out the JD(U)'s simmering discontentment with the chief minister in the open again as Singh is not the first one to voice his differences with Nitish. The recent reinduction of Upendra Kushwaha into the party triggered Singh's resignation but the bigger clash in the JD(U) is over which social class will dominate

in matters of the party. Though party President Sharad Yadav has not accepted Lallan's resignation, the Lok Sabha MP says he will not withdraw it. With Assembly polls this year, it looks like Nitish has his work—and future prospects—cut out. **by Amitabh Srivastava**



West Bengal Governor and former NSA M.K. Narayanan couldn't resist visiting Intelligence Bureau Director Rajiv Mathur in his office. Propriety issues could be raised. Not when Mathur hosted a dinner for the ex-NSA though.

BHOPAL | Picking Up the Waste

Twenty-five years after the Bhopal Gas Tragedy, the ghost of the world's worst industrial disaster is set for a burial. On January 28, the Supreme Court ordered the shifting of the toxic waste from the Union Carbide chemical plant to Pithampur industrial area near Indore. Activists working for the survivors of the disaster have alleged that the uncontained waste has polluted ground-water supplied to low-income localities in the area. The state Government and the Centre have played down these accusations of toxicity. Union Minister of State for Environment and Forests Jairam Ramesh even picked up the toxic waste during his visit to Bhopal last year to claim it was harmless. In

THE UNION CARBIDE PLANT

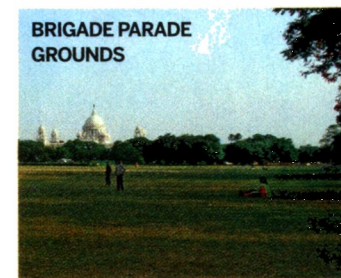


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response to a PIL, the Madhya Pradesh High Court had earlier ordered disposal of the waste at Ankaleshwar in Gujarat. However, the Gujarat Government had moved the Supreme Court against the order. **by Ambresh Mishra**

KOLKATA | Play Ground

A tussle is on between the CPI(M) and the Congress over renaming the famous Brigade Parade Grounds and the key rivals are Jyoti Basu and Indira Gandhi. Ramola, widow of CPI(M) minister Subhas Chakraborty, has asked the prime minister and the Defence Ministry to name it after late chief minister Jyoti Basu. State



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Congress leaders Abdul Mannan and Subrata Mukherjee have petitioned Sonia Gandhi and Pranab Mukherjee to name the ground after Indira Gandhi. It was here that the late prime minister had received word of the Pakistani attack in 1971. Subrata says, "The Bangladesh war remains Indira Gandhi's single-most important achievement as prime minister. The Brigade was witness to an historic moment. We have to immortalise that moment." Ramola's counter: "Basu addressed mass gatherings here."

by Abhijit Dasgupta